

REPLACE

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHAT

FOR WHY-HOW · HOW-WHY

The WHAT-Partner Cadence

A structured pairing with a WHAT-primary who owns pace-setting for a defined piece of work. **Momentum becomes someone's energizing job instead of your draining one.**

THE DRAIN

Every method in this collection reduces the cost of momentum work; none of it makes that work energizing, because for WHY-HOW and HOW-WHY profiles it never will be. On long or high-stakes work, self-managed pace has a failure rate that no worksheet fully fixes.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The cadence protocol formalizes what the framework calls a structural partnership need. A WHAT-primary partner takes explicit ownership of pace: milestones, check-ins, and the standing question "what ships this week?" For them the role is energizing. For you it removes the heaviest recurring drain entirely.

The cadence agreement

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| 1 Who sets pace | The partner owns dates, check-in rhythm, and the shipping question. |
| 2 The rhythm | A fixed check-in, weekly or twice-weekly, fifteen minutes, no agenda beyond movement. |
| 3 What the partner can call | Slipping milestones, threads over the WIP cap, thresholds drifting upward. |
| 4 What stays yours | Depth, quality, and direction. The partnership divides energy, not authority. |
| 5 The trade | What you carry for them in return, usually depth review or purpose framing. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Choose a genuine WHAT-primary.** The pairing works because pace-setting energizes them. A reluctant partner recreates the drain, twice.
- 2 Write the agreement in one page.** Roles, rhythm, call-outs, trade. Ambiguity is where partnerships curdle.
- 3 Let them push, by contract.** When they press on a date, that is the agreement functioning, not a judgment of you.
- 4 Review the pairing monthly.** Ten minutes: is the trade balanced, is the rhythm right, does it continue?

WHAT IT WON'T DO

This is a partnership, not a rescue; it fails if framed as the partner compensating for a deficiency rather than completing a team. The framework is explicit, collaboration needs are requirements. And the trade must be real, a one-way cadence becomes supervision, and nobody signed up for that.

IN THE KIT

One-page cadence agreement

Check-in script

Monthly review card

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 33 Team Trade Board · **Tool 17** The Momentum Board · **Tool 10** HOW-Partner Review Protocol